301. Professional Communication

College of Information Science and Engineering, Ritsumeikan University

301. Professional Communication

Course objectives

This course teaches students to **communicate effectively** with a variety of audiences, **professional** and other. This course will develop both **writing** and **communication** skills simultaneously. In this course students will undertake a variety of projects including **writing a curriculum vitae** and a **cover letter**. In addition to this, students will develop their **oral presentation skills**, learn how to make effective visual content for a presentation, and gain experience with a variety of presentation tools. **All aspects of this course aim to simulate the working environment**.

Assignments & Grading
Your teacher will provide you with more detailed information of these grades as the semester progresses.

Write your own Curriculum Vitae (CV) 履歴書 **10%**

Write your own Cover Letter 10%

Take part in a Mock Job Interview 模擬面接
Interview performance 20%
Peer review 5%

Perform a Group Presentation
Presentation Performance 20%
Peer review 5%

Classwork 30%
Minus points can also be received as per CISE policy. Classwork includes performance during group assignments, e.g., ability to work as part of a group, reviewing the work of classmates, etc.

Week	Theme
1	What is professional communication? Introduction to the course. Overview of course assignments
2	Making a Curriculum Vitae (CV)
3	CV Peer Review **Draft curriculum vitae due**
4	Making a Cover Letter Previewing the Job Interview Assignment
5	Cover Letter Peer Review Mock Interviews Preparation **Draft cover letter due**
6	Mock Interviews Preparation
7	Job Interviews (1)
8	Job Interviews (2) **Final curriculum vitae due** **Final cover letter due**
9	Group Presentation: Instructions, topic choice and Group Formation
10	Group Presentation: Signposting in Presentations
11	Group Presentation: Handover Phrases and Techniques
12	Group Presentation: Final Preparations and rehearsal
13	Group Presentation Performance (1) **Final presentation slides due**
14	Group Presentation Performance (2) Student reflection on Course Assignments

WEEK 1

Starting in the next class, you will be writing your own Curriculum Vitae (CV) or resume, and in Week 4 you will write a Cover Letter. What are these two documents?

What is a CV and what is it used for?

- A CV, short for curriculum vitae, is a document that displays your education, work experience, skills, and other relevant information in a structured style. It is usually used when applying for jobs to showcase your qualifications and suitability for a role in a company.

- A CV provides a view of your professional background, achievements, and abilities, and allows employers to assess your suitability for a job. Often, if the company likes the CV that you sent them, they will invite you to an interview.

What is a Cover Letter and what is it used for?

- A cover letter is a document that complements your CV and is sent to the company you wish to join. The cover letter highlights your qualifications, skills, strengths, and experience relevant to the job you are applying for.

- The cover letter is used to grab the attention of the reader, and create a positive first impression, aiming to secure an interview.

What is the difference between a CV and a Cover Letter?

The main difference between a CV and a Cover Letter is that a **CV is written in a chronological list format with bullet-points**, whereas a **Cover Letter is more like an essay with several paragraphs**, which gives more detail than a CV. Also, a Cover Letter is often tailored to the specific job you are trying to get.

In many countries, when people apply for jobs, they need to send both the CV and Cover Letter to the company they wish to join.

You will create these two documents in the coming weeks of this course. We will not send the documents to a company, but we will be using them in the mock interviews 模擬面接 which will happen in class later in the semester.

Thinking about your CV and Cover Letter

In pairs or small groups, ask each other the question below. This conversation about your achievements should help you when you start writing your CV and Cover Letter in upcoming lessons.

Question:

What has been your biggest achievement so far in your life?

a) Inside education (i.e., at school or university)
b) Outside of education

Give your answers for A and B.

Notes:

Homework

After your conversation, please write a short paragraph about your own big life achievement(s) inside and outside of education.

Upload your paragraph to Manaba Assignments before the next class. There is no score for this task. It is designed to make you start thinking about your own good points and strengths, which will be important when making a CV and Cover Letter.

WEEK 2

Assignment 1. Writing your Curriculum Vitae (CV) 履歴書

A CV summarises your **achievements, education history, experiences, qualities (strengths) and qualifications.**

Think about yourself and **your good points**. In the box below, write down some words which describe you. Not physical descriptions, but the **positive points of your character.** You can also write down some **positive experiences** you've had in your life.

You can use some of these words and phrases when you create your own CV and Cover Letter.

~~tall~~	I'm friendly	worked as a waiter
~~black hair~~	climbed Mount Fuji	Basketball circle
I studied abroad	hard-working	

Before you start writing your own CV, let's look at examples of good and bad CVs so you can see what you should and should not do when you start writing.

With a partner, look at the two CVs from Hanako below. Let's compare the two versions….

Hanako Ritsumei *hanaritsu@ba.ritsumei.ac.jp*
525-8577 Japan Shiga, Kusatsu-City 1-1-1 Nojihigashi, 077-566-1111

EDUCATION:
University: Ritsumeikan University in Japan
***Major**: Information Science and Engineering*
***Seminar**: Future energies and renewable technologies*
***Degree**: Graduate in Information Science and Engineering (March 2024)*

Study-abroad experience:
Florida International Univercity in Florida (August 2020 - May2021)
・ ・ I won a scholarship from Ritsumaikan University to study in Florida International University as an exchange student for 10 months
・ ・ Got International Student Honor (2020)
・
AWARDS/ACHIEVEMENTS:

Got a seminar business competition in 2022 in Ritsumeiknan University
・ Searched and analyzed SPA business model and international markets of FAST RETAILING USA, Inc.
Piano Grade 5 (December 2021)
TOEIC Score (730) (June, 2017)
Bookkeeping rank3 (2022)
Bookkeeping rank 2 (2022)

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY (PART-TIME JOB):
・Worked at a restaurant "Hokka-Hokka-Tei" (May2022-Jooly2023) in Kobe, JAPAN
・Volunteer guide TEDxKyoto one-day event (2020, 2022)
・*Hire* at a information desk of Universal City Walk in Osaka, JAPAN (June-September2021)

OTHER
Got Japanese driver's license
In volunteer circle as "Oritor" during college life.
Nissho bokki Level 2

Draft 1

Hanako Ritsumei

1-1-1 Nojihigashi, Kusatsu-City
Shiga, 525-8577, Japan
(+81) 77-566-1111
hanaritsu@ba.ritsumei.ac.jp

Education

Aug 2020-May 2021 **Florida International University, USA** (exchange student)
Study Abroad Scholarship Winner

Apr 2020-present **Ritsumeikan University, Faculty of Business Administration**
Major: International Business,
Area of study: Future Energies and Renewable Technologies
Due to graduate: March 2024 / Current GPA: 4.6

Employment History

May 2022-Jul 2023 **Hokka-Hokka-Tei Restaurant, Kobe, Serving Team**
Took orders from customers and dealt with bills. Worked as part of a team

Aug-Dec 2019 **Universal Studios Japan, Osaka, Customer Service Team**
Helped Japanese and foreign guests. Sold tickets at ticket booth and handed out maps

Other Experience and Achievements

2020, 2022 **TEDxKyoto One-day Event Volunteer Guide**
Set-up venue and welcomed guests. Handed out flyers and snacks

Jul 2022 **Ritsumeikan University Seminar Business Competition Winner**
Researched and presented international business models to an audience of professors and peers

Feb 2020-Jan 2021 **Faculty of Business Administration Orientation Team Member**
Planned and organised welcome activities for guests and worked as part of a small team

Qualifications

2022 *Shoukou Kaigisho*, Bookkeeping Test **Level 2**
2021 Test of English for International Communication (TOEIC) **730 (max. 990)**
2020 Driving Licence

Final Draft

(additional example of a good CV)

Toru Ritsumei

1-1-1 Nojihigashi, Kusatsu-City
Shiga, 525-8577, JAPAN
077-566-1111
toruritsumei@st.ritsumei.ac.jp

Education

Apr 2021-present ***Ritsumeikan University, College of Information Science and Engineering***
Global Course,
Research Field: Using ICT to save indigenous languages
Due to graduate: March 2019 / Current GPA: 4.6

Apr 2017-Mar 2020 ***Ritsumeikan High School***
English Course

Employment History

Jun-Sep 2021 ***Customer Service Team,*** Universal Studios Japan, Osaka
Managed a customer service desk at the theme park; explained in Japanese and English different options to customers. Learned the value of clear communication and patience.

May 2020-Dec 2020 ***Serving Team,*** Hokka-Hokka-Tei Restaurant, Kobe
Ensured that orders were delivered to diners in a prompt and efficient manner; handled final bills and payment. Experienced the excitement of a busy working environment and teamwork.

Other Experience and Achievements

Jul 2022 ***Internship,*** **ABM company**
Part of a team of four, we developed an online store to sell the products of the company. Responsible for coding using C++, database management, and security implementation.

Mar 2022 ***Volunteer,*** **Ritsumeikan University, Biwako Campus Orientation Team**
In charge of planning and organising welcome activities, identifying issues for new students and dealing with problems.

May 2021 ***Winner,*** **Young application developer of the year**
Part of a team which developed an ios application to detect key words used in cyber bullying.

Qualifications

2023 Programming certificate
2022 Test of English for International Communication (TOEIC) 730 (Max. 990)

Additional Advice for Writing a CV

Using different verbs to make your CV sound better:

Read example A below. Notice the verbs which are used (underlined in **bold**).

Example A

*At university I **did** lots of research into human resources planning. I **made** presentations on this to the class.*

Now read example B below. Notice the verbs which are used. It sounds much more professional

Example B

*At university I **analysed** human resources planning, **identified** why it was successful, and **presented** my research to my peers in class.*

Note that on a CV where you are summarising information, we often omit personal pronouns like 'I' and also small words like 'the'.

The 3 Cs: (Chronology, Clarity, Consistency)

1. Chronology:

The simplest way of listing information on a CV is to do it chronologically or in time order. If you do this, the employer can see your history quickly and effectively even in just a few seconds. You could start each section with your most recent achievements or with your oldest ones.

Oldest first:

1999-2004	Takeda Elementary School, Kyoto
2004-2009	Kyoto Prefectural Junior and Senior High School, Kyoto
2009-present	Ritsumeikan University, Kyoto

Most recent first:

2009-present	Ritsumeikan University, Kyoto
2004-2009	Kyoto Prefectural Junior and Senior High School, Kyoto
1999-2004	Takeda Elementary School, Kyoto

2. Clarity:

If you are going to catch the eye of an employer, he or she must be able to understand

the contents of your CV. Writing clearly is important, but you must also use space and font styles (**bold**, *italics*, etc.) effectively. If your CV is too dense it will be difficult to read, so add lines of space between sections and indent different information within sections using the Tab button.

3. Consistency (format):

If your CV has any problems with its format the employer might throw it away. Problems with consistency are very obvious. These are things like different sized fonts, mixture of English / Japanese sized characters, different spacing between sections etc. To avoid consistency problems always proofread your final work.

Homework

- You need to make a first draft of your CV with details about you and your life
- Use the pages above to help you.
- Write it in Microsoft Word. **PRINT IT**. **Bring it to class next week** for peer review
- Font: Times New Roman, size 12 (bigger for title and your name if you like)
- If you do not want to write your real home address, use the Ritsumeikan address which is in Hanako's CV

WEEK 3

CV – Peer Review

This peer review should be done in small groups.

Please remember that part of your 'Classwork' score on this course includes your performance during group assignments, e.g., your ability to work as part of a group, reviewing the work of classmates, etc.

- Peer Review time! This is a very important stage of the course. Check the CV of the other members of your group and give them advice
- You become the teacher
- Compare the CV to Hanako's 'good' version and the advice in the booklet
- Look again at the 3 Cs
- Carefully check for spelling and grammar errors
- Be strict! Show any mistakes you find to the writer so they can correct the errors

Homework

- Use the advice from today's peer review and write the final version of your CV.
- Keep the document safe on your PC
- You will upload it to Manaba later in the course alongside your Cover Letter

Body Language

Later in this course you have an interview assignment and a presentation assignment.

Good body language in a job interview or business presentation could make the difference between getting the job, making a successful presentation or not.

Watch some of the following short videos. Make a list of the good and bad examples of body language you see. Compare these examples with a partner and discuss why you think they are good/bad.

WEEK 4

The main task today is to start writing your own Cover Letter, but before we look at that, let's just have a short preview of the job you will be applying for when we do the mock interviews 模擬面接 later in the course.

TASK: Look at the job advertisement below and read through it.

- Imagine you are job-hunting, and you find this job on *jp.indeed.com* or another job website 仕事探し
- This is the job you and Hanako will try to get when we do the mock interviews in class 模擬面接 in Week 7 & 8
- The job you will apply for: Software development engineer at Apple, Tokyo
- With a partner, look at the job advertisement below and answer the quiz questions (all the answers are somewhere in the advertisement)

(The job you and Hanako are applying for)

JOB ADVERTISEMENT
Apple: Software Development Engineer

Location: Tokyo, Japan
Job reference number (include in cover letter): T17132
Job type: University graduate entry level (no prior experience necessary)

About Apple
We are based in California but create, design, and develop technology across the world. Our mission is to bring the best user experience to customers through innovative hardware, software, and services, and to make the best products on earth. Our employees work cooperatively in teams and are creative with good communication skills. We are also a modern company with a flat organizational structure, and we want people who share our mission.

The Role
The **Software Development Engineer** will work in our Tokyo based research department. The candidate will be part of a team of highly skilled and motivated Engineers developing the most innovative technology to share with the world.

Responsibilities
- Work in a R&D team to help create and develop software for Apple products
- Communicate clearly with other team members, coders, engineers, and management
- Give monthly presentations to management and investors
- Occasionally give talks to visiting members of the public in Apple Stores

Requirements / Qualifications
- A university degree in Information Science
- Business English and Japanese communication skills. Additional languages an

advantage.

- Presentation skills in English and Japanese
- Enthusiasm and passion for creating new and innovative technology
- A valid driver's license and a safe driving record

Application Instructions

Applicants should send a CV and cover letter in an A4 envelope to: Apple Tokyo, Shibuya Minami, Shibuyamiyamachi 2-4-23, 777-7777, Japan. "Application for software Engineer" should be written in red pen on the back of the envelope.

Job Advertisement Quiz

1. What is the position being advertised?

_____
_____
_____
_____

2. Where is the job?

_____
_____
_____
_____

3. What does Apple do?

_____
_____
_____
_____

4. What is Apple's main area of business?

Manufacturing & Design / Service industry / Education / Healthcare

5. How old would a suitable candidate for this job probably be?

_____
_____
_____
_____

6. How many requirements / qualifications are mentioned?

_____
_____
_____
_____

7. How is the company structured?

_____
_____

Assignment 2. Writing your Cover Letter

Before you have an interview in Week 7 & 8, you need to make another document – A Cover Letter

Your CV and Cover Letter go together when you apply for a job in an English-speaking country

We will use these two documents during the interviews in Week 7 & 8.

Let's look at examples of good and bad Cover Letters so you can see what you should and should not do when you start writing.

With a partner, look at the two Cover Letters from Hanako below. Let's compare the two versions….

(Hanako's cover letter - first draft)

Hanako Ritsumei
December 22nd 2023

Apple Tokyo,
Shibuya Minami,
Shibuyamiyamachi
2-4-23, 777-7777,
Japan

Dear Mr Apple,
Applying for the job

Hello! I am writing to apply for the position of software engineer position which was advertised on your website. You will think I am perfect for this job because my skills and experiences are perfect for it.

You specify that you are looking for someone who can develop software, strong English and give presentations. I have all these things. Moreover I am punctual, passionate and enthusiasm. I studied IT at uni and got a software developers licence. These skills are gonna be useful for you. In addition, I was an oritor, so I have experience helping and communicating with people. As a result, I learned how to cooperate successful with others and got excellent organisational skills. I also have experience studying abroad so I am a global person. Therefore I will be a great specialist at Apple.

I have a strong interest in new technologies and innovation. My smart phone is my favourite possession and I would like to make new app designs in the future. While at university I did a lot of group work and learned IT in English, and I enjoy working with others. I also have experience of customer service in a busy Japanese restaurant where I had to be flexible to make customers' experience enjoyable. Sometimes I argued with my manager but I liked my co-workers. Finally, I have a valid driver's license and am a safe driver.

I'm a funny and interesting person and my develppers license, practical experience, and eagerness to enter the software development industry will make me an excellent engineer. If possible, I would like to meet you.

Thank you for reading.

Hanako

Draft 1

(Hanako's cover letter - final draft)

1-1-1 Nojihigashi,
Kusatsu City,
Shiga, 525-8577
Japan
December 22nd, 2023

Apple Tokyo,
Shibuya Minami,
Shibuyamiyamachi
2-4-23, 777-7777,
Japan

Job Reference Number: T17132

Dear Sir / Madam,

I am writing to apply for the position of **Software Development Engineer** which was advertised on your website. As somebody with the skills and experience listed in the job advertisement and a passion for innovative technologies, I believe I am a suitable candidate for this role.

In March 2024 I will graduate from Ritsumeikan University with a degree in Information Science and Engineering. For the last two years as a student, I focused on coding and development of A.I. technologies, an area which I am passionate about. I made many presentations and wrote reports on the subject and became deeply interested in the impact this technology can have on our lives. I also studied English and was an exchange student in America, so I am confident communicating in English. In addition, at university I was a member of the orientation team which was responsible for helping new students, something I really enjoyed. Through this experience I learned to cooperate and help others as part of a team, and so I believe I would enjoy working in an Apple research department.

Though I have some understanding of software development, I am keen to have a career in which I can both use this knowledge and learn more. By working for Apple, I could achieve these goals while helping Apple achieve its aim of creating, designing, and developing technology for use across the world. I am particularly attracted to the flat hierarchical organization which would allow me to contribute to all levels of the company. As you can see from my CV I have relevant work experience in customer service, something that was challenging but fun. I also have a bookkeeping qualification (Level 2) so I know how to keep accurate financial records, something which would be important in this job.

I am confident that my CV shows how I could be a beneficial addition to Apple, and I would be very grateful if I could meet you for an interview.

Yours sincerely,
Hanako Ritsumei

Final Draft

Additional Advice for Writing a Cover Letter

Just like a CV, a good cover letter is essential when looking for a job. Many large companies receive so many job applications that they only spend around 30 seconds looking at each Cover Letter. Your Cover Letter must impress the reader quickly!

A Cover Letter should clearly state why this company should hire you. Everything it includes should encourage the company to give your CV more attention.

1. Research the Company!

Before you write your cover letter, do some research on the company and the job you are applying for. What does the company do?

Carrying out this research will give you the knowledge you need to tailor your cover letter and will prepare you for an interview. It will also show that you have a real interest in the job and the company.

2. Addressing your cover letter

When writing a cover letter, you should always try to address the letter to the person handling job applications. This is usually listed in the job advertisement. If you know the person, write Dear Mr Smith (for a man) / Dear Ms Smith (for a woman). **If you do not know the name of the person in charge of hiring, then write Dear Sir / Madam.**

3. What to include in your cover letter

a. First paragraph

The opening paragraph should be short and explain why you are writing, e.g. "I am writing to apply for the role of Branch Manager at McDonald's". It is also useful to include where you found the job advertisement, e.g. "I found your advertisement on indeed.jp".

b. Second paragraph

Why are you suitable for the job? Briefly describe your academic and professional qualifications that are relevant to the role and ensure **you refer to each of the skills listed in the job description.**

c. Third paragraph

Here is your opportunity to emphasise what you can do for the company. Outline your career goals (i.e., what you imagine yourself doing in that company in the future).

d. Fourth paragraph

Like the first paragraph this one should be quite short. Here is where you restate your interest in the job and why you would be suitable. It is also a good time to ask the company for an interview.

Homework

- **Write the first draft of your cover letter**. **PRINT IT**. Bring it to the next class for peer review.
- Review the advice above about writing a 4-paragraph cover letter
- Check the Apple job advertisement above and highlight key words and points you should mention in your letter. Hanako's cover letter will also help you
- Look at your CV as you write and try to put <u>your</u> good character points into your cover letter
- **Do not copy Hanako's good points. Add your own good points and your own education/study details.**

WEEK 5

Today we are going to start preparing for the mock interviews 模擬面接 which are coming in Weeks 7 & 8, but first we need to peer review your Cover Letter.

Cover Letter – Peer Review

This peer review should be done in small groups.

Please remember that part of your 'Classwork' score on this course includes your performance during group assignments, e.g., your ability to work as part of a group, reviewing the work of classmates, etc.

- Peer Review time! This is a very important stage of the course. Check the Cover Letters of the other members of your group and give them advice
- You become the teacher
- Compare the Cover Letters to Hanako's 'good' version and the advice above
- Carefully check for spelling and grammar errors
- Be strict! Show any mistakes you find to the writer so they can correct the errors

Homework

- Use the advice from today's peer review and write the final version of your Cover Letter.
- Keep the document safe on your PC
- You will upload it to Manaba later in the course, alongside your CV

NOTE – You must bring paper copies of your CV and Cover Letter to the interviews in Weeks 7 & 8. The teacher will give you details in the next class.

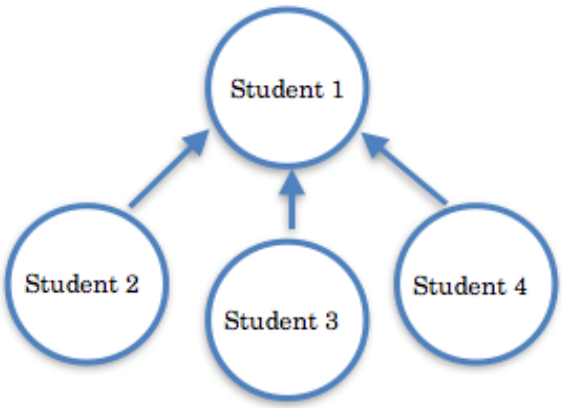
Assignment 3: The Mock Interviews 模擬面接 - Preparation

- The interviews will take place in Weeks 7 and 8.
- Next week (week 6), you will be in groups of around 4 people.
- Your group members will interview each other.
- You will be the interviewee once, and for the other interviews you will be an interviewer (see diagram below).
- One interview will take around 20 minutes in total: Preparation = 5 mins. Interview = 10 mins. Scoring = 5 mins.

Job Interview Information

Please note for this course your job interview will be conducted in groups using the rubric in this booklet. You will be responsible for scoring the students that you interview, so it is very important that you treat this task seriously.

Interview Setup
Interview 1
Interviewee



To prepare for the interviews, we need to look at both sides – the **interviewee** and the **interviewer(s)**.

In this class we will look at the **interviewee**. Of course, their main role in an interview is to answer the questions given to them by the interviewer(s), but sometimes it is important for the interviewee to ask one or two questions to show that they are interested in the company they wish to join.

TASK: In small groups, please do some online research and **write down some common <u>interviewee</u> questions** which could be asked in an interview.

For example: **What are some of the main challenges of this job?**

<u>Job Interview preparation: types of questions</u>

There are two types of question you will be asked in the interview.

1. Questions which ask about factual information: e.g. How long did you study abroad?
2. Questions which invite you to talk about your experiences: e.g. Could you tell me about your experience studying abroad?

Although they cannot always be divided simply in this way, it's clear that you will give a short answer to **type 1 questions** and a longer answer to **type 2 questions**. However, remember that in a job interview you are expected to show how you are suitable for the role and why you are a better candidate than everybody else. This is particularly important for type 2 questions.

<u>Example Interview question:</u>
Could you tell me about your experience studying abroad?

<u>Answer A:</u> I went to the University of California for eight months and I had a great time.

<u>Answer B:</u> I went to the University of California for eight months and I had a great time experiencing American culture. The weather was great the whole time and there's only really one season so it was really stress-free choosing clothes to wear. And there are such a lot of outdoor activities to do that I got really fit.

<u>Answer C:</u> I went to the University of California for eight months and I had a great time experiencing American culture. In particular I enjoyed interacting with lots of students from other cultures because I learned a lot about the world. I also got to take lectures in English which helped my English improve.

Homework

Below are some short videos which will help you prepare for your job interview in Weeks 7 & 8.

Please watch as many of these videos as you can.

WEEK 6

The Mock Interviews 模擬面接 - Preparation

- The interviews will start next week
- In today's class we will create some **interviewer questions** which you can use next week

Before we start, let's create groups for the interviews. This will be your group for the interviews for the next two weeks

Job interview preparation: predicting the questions and practicing your answers

Generally, job interviews are aiming to find out the same information about you. What type of person you are, whether you can do the job and why they should choose you instead of anybody else. Because of this, a lot of job interview questions are predictable.

In addition, by carefully reading the job advertisement you can probably predict other questions that might be asked.

TASK:

Predicting/Writing/Communication
Here are six typical job interview questions. Think about your answers, then with a partner practice answering them. Below each question is a space to write notes. Do not try to memorise your answers as you will not be able to remember them word for word. You will also appear awkward and lacking in confidence and not get the job.

1. **Why have you applied for this job?**

2. **Can you tell me why you want to work for our company?**

3. **What are your strengths?**

4. **Have you ever been in charge of something like a team or a volunteer group?**

5. **How do you feel about working in groups?**

6. **Tell me what you learned at university.**

7. _____?

8. _____?

9. _____?

10. _____?

PLEASE ADD LOTS MORE QUESTIONS TO THE ABOVE LIST!!!

Rules for the interview next week:

- **Interviewee - No notes**! You can only have your CV and cover letter during the interview.
- Interviewee answers must come from memory.
- Interviewers (Apple staff) – Notes and questions on paper are OK.
- **Nobody can use a PC – paper only.**

Homework and Checklist:

- **4 copies of your CV** and **4 copies of your cover letter** (1 for you. 1 for each member of your group) **Print them!**
- **Print** a list of interviewers (Apple staff) questions on paper (not in booklet).
- Do NOT bring interviewee questions or answers. These must come from your memory.
- Think about how to **answer** the questions you will hear in your interview.

Interview Rubric:

Interview Skills	Poor	Fair	Good	Excellent
Preparation and first impression	Shows up late for the interview, does not shake hands, and/or chews gum; does not bring a copy of the resume or references Does not illustrate knowledge about the company or seems to make up information as he/she goes along	Shows up on time for the interview. Does not bring a copy of the resume. Does not illustrate knowledge about the company or seems to make up information as he/she goes along	Shows up on time for the interview with a copy of the resume in hand Knows some general information about the company and/or its purpose	Shows up early for the interview with a copy of the resume in hand Has researched the company and the position thoroughly and is apparent by answers given in response to questions
Quality of questions and responses	Answers with "yes" or "no" and fails to elaborate or explain; talks negatively about past employers. Asked very few questions during interview.	Asked some questions for information or answered questions with limited answers that need further elaboration or gives well-constructed responses, but sounds rehearsed or unsure.	Asked appropriate and original questions and give well-constructed responses with specific examples	Asked original questions and gives well-constructed, confident responses with excellent examples that are genuine.

Body language and general attitude	Lack of interest and enthusiasm about the position; passive and indifferent; or overly enthusiastic. Limited eye contact> Doesn't make a confident impression	Seems interested in the position but could be better prepared or informed on certain topics. Sometimes eye contact is limited and/or comes across as insecure.	Interested in the position and enthusiastic about the interview. Good eye contact and poise during interview.	Shows a great deal of interest in the position and is very enthusiastic about the interview. Excellent eye contact and poise during interview. Makes a confident impression
Likelihood of being hired	very little chance of getting the job	50/50 chance of getting the job	would probably get the job	would definitely get the job

Language	**Poor**	**Fair**	**Good**	**Excellent**
Grammar and vocabulary	Grammatical errors severely hampered communication.	Grammatical errors led to many minor difficulties or one major breakdown in communication	A few minor difficulties arose from not using appropriate grammar and vocabulary. Student uses expressions from syllabus sufficiently	A variety of grammar was used to communicate effectively. Student used extensive vocabulary and expressions from syllabus
Voice and fluency	Pronunciation, inflection, and/or expression confused communication. Student may have been very difficult to hear. Was dependent on interviewer to keep the conversation going	Some communication problems arose due to unclear pronunciation and/or lack of inflection and/or expression. Student may have been difficult to hear. Some effort was required to maintain the conversation. There may have been a few long pauses.	No serious problems arose, but better pronunciation, inflection, and/or non-verbal communication could have made communication more efficient. Some minor difficulties maintaining the conversation were evident.	Pronunciation was clear and inflection and expressions were used to enhance communication. Student acted as a facilitator, helping the conversation flow and develop.

Comprehe nsion and listening	Student was unable to comprehend questions. Questions had to be repeated. Student didn't understand or ignored most questions and statements. Student may have been using notes.	The student showed little comprehension of questions. Questions had to be repeated. Student failed to answer some questions appropriately OR failed to acknowledge some statements and incorporate these into the conversation.	The student understood most of what was asked of him/her. Student responded to most questions, acknowledged most statements, and incorporated many of these into the conversation.	The student fully understood the questions asked and answered correctly. Student responded to questions with appropriate answers, acknowledged all statements, and incorporated them into the discussion.

WEEK 7 & WEEK 8

Interviews take place in the classroom

Please use supplementary documents for this assignment, provided by your teacher

Homework 1: CV & Cover Letter Upload

Upload your CV and your Cover Letter to Manaba Assignments レポート before the next class

Homework 2: Interview Reflection

- Manaba > 301 class page > forum (スレッド一覧)
- Every student must post their opinion
- Please answer the questions on our class Manaba page before the next class!
- Comments = 5% of your final score
- Make sure you answer in the correct group. Remember your group letter (A,B,C….)

WEEK 9

Assignment 4: Group Business Presentation

- The final assignment for this course is a group Business presentation.
- The planning will start today. The presentations will take place in Weeks 13 & 14
- A detailed schedule and instructions will be available on Manaba Course News

- You will need to work together as a group both at home (online) **and** in the classroom (face to face). The final performance will be face to face in the class
- **The topic must be connected to the world of Information Science**
- The presentation must be **12-15 minutes long**
- Every group member must speak equally
- The work must be shared equally
- You get + or – points for group work
- The teacher will score your presentation. Other groups in the class will also score you.
- This assignment is 20% of your semester score
- You will be scored for English grammar, accuracy and use of business English phrases which will be given to you by the teacher.
- Scores will also be given for slide design and quality
- You will also be scored for teamwork
- **It is strongly recommended to share your presentation work on Google Drive, OneDrive or something similar, so you can all work on the presentation together remotely**

Before we start, let's create groups for the presentations. This will be your group for the remainder of the course

Brainstorming your topic

Remember. Your topic must be connected to the world of Information Science

Your group cannot have the same topic as another group, so if you have a great topic idea, tell the teacher quickly before another group takes your idea!

- **In your group, decide on your topic. When you have made a final decision, ask the teacher for approval**
- Then **email** your topic to the teacher:

To: TEACHER@fc.ritsumei.ac.jp
Subject (件名) : 301 Presentation Topic and **group name A,B,C…**
Inside the email: All member names and topic title
Email deadline: before next lesson! (Only 1 email per group)

WEEK 10

Signposting in presentations

In your upcoming presentation, there are some key words and phrases which you MUST use. In this lesson we will look at these phrases.

- Signposting is the use of key words and phrases during a presentation which act as a guide for the audience
- These phrases have key functions in a presentation, - **they tell the audience what is coming next, or when a topic has ended**
- Listen to this short presentation (audio only) and fill in the key signpost phrases below
- Use the phrases from part 1 of the worksheet to complete part 2

301. Signposting Audio Exercise

Part 1: Listen carefully to the short presentation. The topic is about traffic problems but the topic is not important. Our goal is to listen out for the ***'signposting' phrases*** the speaker uses. Fill in the gaps as you listen….

OK, *(1)* _____ ***the background*** and the reason we developed the programme. Any questions? OK. ***So,*** *(2)*_____ ***to the next point*** and take a closer look at the Traffic Support Centre itself. *(3)*_____**,** the TSC was set up in 2001 to help traffic flow more smoothly, and basically to make the lives of motorists easier. ***In this part of my presentation*** *(4)*_____ ***you about*** the centre's activities, how we work exactly and how motorists benefit from our services.

So, *(5)* _____ ***a brief overview*** of the TSC's activities. Our main activities are to collect, analyse and communicate traffic information. After collecting traffic data from a number of different sources, we analyse them and then we inform the media, the police, or other authorities, and – last but not least – the motorists….

This now leads us to *(6)* _____. How does the TSC collect data? Traffic monitoring equipment has been installed across the main traffic routes, which helps us gather real-time information on traffic speed and traffic flow.

Additionally, we use variable traffic sensors and cameras. We also work together with other partners and authorities, for example, the police, traffic officers, and the media. Let me show you a few examples of how this works…. *(7)*_____ collecting data.

*(8)*_____ ***to the next issue***. How do we communicate information to motorists? We do this in a number of ways: by using electronic road signs, the internet and radio, and state-of-the-art phone technology….

Let me now come back to *(9)*_____**.** The TSC wants to make the lives of motorists easier. So, in what ways does the motorist benefit? Well, …. First: through real-time information about the traffic situation. Second, through better advice about alternative routes. Third, through safer roads and less driver stress.

Part 2: These signposting phrases are used to help the presentation audience understand what is happening during a presentation. Complete this box of useful phrases using the phrases in part 1

Try to use some of these key phrases when you perform your presentation!

Telling the audience what is coming next

1. In this part of my presentation, I'd like to tell you about….

2. _____

Moving on the next topic/point

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

Indicating the end of a section

6. _____

7. _____

Referring back

As I mentioned before…

8. _____

Let's go back to what we were discussing earlier.

9. _____

Summarising a point

I'd like to sum up the main points.

Let me briefly summarise what I've said so far.

Presentation Group Work

For the remainder of this lesson, please get into your presentation group and continue to create your speech script and your slides.

The teacher will come to visit each group so progress can be discussed.

If you have any problems or issues, please let the teacher know.

WEEK 11

Handover Phrases and Methods in presentations

- As you know, in this presentation you are expected to change the role of 'speaker'

regularly. Everyone needs to speak

- This means that you need to hand over the speaking duty (and pass the microphone) in a smooth and efficient manner
- Today we will look at some common ways of handing over to another person during a presentation
- It's not difficult, but it needs to be practiced so you can do it smoothly and correctly

Please watch these short videos. They are simple advice on how to hand over speaking duty to the next speaker.

You MUST use these phrases in your presentation

Handing over the speaking duty (microphone) in 3 easy steps:

Step 1 - Signal that <u>your</u> speaking part is ending

You can do this in several ways….

- "This is the end of my point on (TOPIC)"
- "So much for (TOPIC)"
- "So that is all I need to say about (TOPIC)"

Step 2 - Hand over to your colleague

There are several common phrases you could use.
They all achieve the same goal of clearly showing the audience that your part has ended and someone else is going to talk.

- "Now I'll hand you over to my colleague/ friend/partner (NAME)"

- “My colleague/partner will take it from here”
- “Now, my colleague/partner (NAME) will talk to you about (TOPIC)”

Step 3 - The new speaker thanks the previous speaker and gives a brief preview of what they are about to talk about

- “Thanks (NAME). I’d like to focus now on ____”
- “Thank you (NAME). I’m going to talk to you about ____”
- “Thanks (NAME). Our next topic is (TOPIC)”

As you can see, the English is pretty easy, but during a presentation people get nervous and it’s easy to make mistakes when handing over

Be sure to include these 3 steps in your presentation and also to REHEARSE the transitions (handing over the microphone)

Presentation Group Work

For the remainder of this lesson, please get into your presentation group and continue to create your speech script and your slides.

The teacher will come to visit each group so progress can be discussed.

If you have any problems or issues, please let the teacher know.

Guidelines about presentations in week 13 and 14:

- Groups will present in random order, so be ready from the start of the lesson with your slideshow and script!
- There are ____ groups in this class, so you may perform in Week 13 OR Week 14.
- Groups must use their own PC/device to display their slideshow. You can try to connect your PC/device today if you like, to see if it works
- Please decide NOW which PC/device you will use next week
- At the start of the next class, every group must give a copy of their slideshow data to the teacher before the presentations start
- After each presentation, your group will judge and score other groups

Homework

As a group, work on your presentation, perfecting handovers, timings, etc. Please make sure to use some of the phrases given to you in recent lessons.

In the next 48 hours after this lesson, each group must email the teacher with a short bullet-point list of what each person will talk about in their presentation. You must show:
1) the topic being discussed by each person.
2) the order in which people will speak.

See below for an example email:

Hello Teacher, we are Group D. Our topic is XXXXXXX. Speaker 1 – Suzuki San: Introduction Speaker 2 – Nakanishi San: The positive aspects of A.I. on the world of education Speaker 3 – Takada San: The negative aspects of A.I. on the world of education Speaker 4 – Sato San: How A.I. will help businesses in the future Speaker 5 – Kuroki San: The dangers of A.I. in business and Conclusion

You will need to bring your computer next week for the TOEIC Achievement Test. Make sure it is fully charged.

WEEK 12

The lesson today will be a TOEIC Achievement Test

WEEK 13 & WEEK 14

Presentations in class

Please use supplementary documents for scoring and assessing the group presentations, provided by your teacher.

Please see the last page of this booklet for the group presentation rubric:

Presentation Feedback & Presentation Reflection

These tasks will take place via Manaba or via supplementary documents supplied by your teacher.

	Excellent	Good	Fair	Poor
Organization	Presentation was very organized and was very easy to follow. Transitions between group members were well planned and executed cleanly.	Presentation was fairly organized and easy to follow. Transitions might have been slightly discontinuous but did not take away greatly from the overall presentation.	Presentation was not clearly organized. Transitions between members were jumpy or awkward.	Presentation lacked organization. Poor transitions between group members individual parts. Presentation lacked order and very difficult to follow.
Teamwork/Participation	The group worked very well with each other, and the presentation was shared equally among the group members.	The group worked well with each other and communicated well. Some members participated slightly more than others.	Group communicated relatively well with a few lapses in the presentation; some students dominated the presentation and others did not participate much.	Group did not work well together. There were obvious miscommunications and lapses in the presentation.
Content	Group members had a stronghold on the content and content was thoroughly addressed. No mistakes were made regarding content knowledge.	Most of the group members has a solid understanding of the content. Content missing minor elements or contained minor errors.	Group members had only a superficial understanding of content. Several mistakes were made during the presentation.	Group members had little to no understanding of the content addressed in the presentation.
Visuals	Group members made eye-contact with audience effectively throughout presentation. Group members were clearly audible throughout	Group members made eye-contact with audience sporadically, but not consistently throughout presentation. Volume was acceptable	Group members lacked eye-contact with audience. Interaction was minimal. Volume was sometimes too low to be able to hear clearly	No eye-contact at all. Volume too low to be able to make themselves heard or understood